



The Better Student App

Course	CSC 225 – Fundamental Structures
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Team Name	The Computer Scientists
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Team Members	Rich Becker
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Executive Summary

Your executive summary should resemble an elevator pitch: your motivation is to quickly persuade a decision maker to get involved in your project.

- What is the purpose of your project; what problem(s) does it address?
- Why is your project important; why is it relevant?
- Who could your project help; who is your audience or customer?

Our project's goal is to be a lightweight academic organizer application for college students. The main aspects of our app will be to manage important class information, upcoming assignments, and grades. Our project is important to help college students stay on top of their workload. Our tool can help students reduce stress and improve organization.

Timeline

Milestone	Name	Due Date
Milestone 1	Group Contract	Thursday, January 23
Milestone 2	Project Plan and Proposal	Tuesday, February 11
Milestone 3	Design & Pitch	Thursday, February 27
Milestone 4	Detailed Tasks	Thursday, March 27
Milestone 5	Progress Presentation	Tuesday, April 15
Milestone 6	Final Presentations	Wednesday, April 30

Milestone Summary

Milestone 1				
Group Contract				
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Create a final project team	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Summary	Self-organize into groups of 3-4 students for working together on the semester project. All team members will need to complete the group contract and agree to its terms, holding each other accountable for contributing to the final project throughout the semester.	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Task M1A – Team Member Names	List all team members with full (first and last) names on the group contract document	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Task M1B – Team Name	Come up with a name for the group/team to be addressed as during presentations; list the name on the group contract document	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Task M1C – Weekly Meeting Time	Block off an hour of time once per week when all team members could regularly meet as necessary throughout the semester; list the time in the group contract document	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Task M1D – Signatures	Each team member signs the group contract document (this may be a digital signature or initials)	0.1	0.1	1/13/2026
Task M1E – Planning Document	Complete the cover page of the planning document, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	0.2	0.2	1/29/2026
Milestone 2				
Project Plan and Proposal				
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Determine final project topic	1	0.2	1/29/2026
Summary	As a group, choose a topic all team members want to work on; discuss potential ideas and come to a group consensus what your project will be and why it is important.	0.5	0.1	1/29/2026

Task M2A – Project Proposal Document	Complete the project proposal document	1		
Task M2B – Presentation	Present the project proposal to the class	0.5		
Task M2C – Planning Document	Complete the executive summary section of the planning document, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	0.2	0.2	2/2/2026
Milestone 3	Design and Pitch			
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Create a general look-and-feel for your project, present your project to the class	6 Hours	6 Hours	2/24/26
Summary	Determine how you want your final project deliverables to look, including color scheme, graphics/images, and placement and layout of major components (e.g. buttons, input fields, data, instructions, etc.). Armed with your project proposal and design mockups, show the class what you plan to accomplish with your project. Think of the class as potential investors or contributors; why should they care about your project?	6 Hours	6 Hours	2/24/26
Task M3A – Major Components	Create a list of major components that will be included in your project (e.g. input/output, images, instructions, etc.)	3 Hours	3 Hours	2/23/26
Task M3B – Color Scheme	Create a color scheme for your project for a consistent design	3 Hours	1.5 Hours	2/23/26
Task M3C – Design Mockups	Create design mockups (use lorem ipsum filler text, at least basic boxes/shapes if not actual design) to show the planned layout of project deliverables, including any major pages/screens that will be included in the final project	6 Hours	6.75 Hours	2/23/26
Task M3D – Presentation	Pitch the project to the class	.75 Hours	.75 Hours	2/24/26
Task M3E – Planning Document	Include screenshots of all design mockups, list of components (labeled for easy identification), screenshots of the project pitch presentation, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	3 Hours	1.5 Hours	2/24/26

Milestone 4		Detailed Task List		
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Plan the remaining tasks required to complete the project	2 Hours	.75 Hours	3/23/26
Summary	As a team, figure out what needs to happen in order to take the project from its current design and planning stage through implementation to completion. Break down each major component of the project to estimate how much work you think it will take to complete, and what detailed tasks/actions will need to be performed for each.	2 Hours	6 Hours	3/24/26
Task M4A – Gantt Chart	Create a Gantt chart showing a detailed task breakdown with expected due dates and assigned team members	1 Hour	2.25 Hours	3/24/26
Task M4B – Presentation	Present your Gantt chart and task list to the class	1 Hour		3/26/26
Task M4C – Planning Document	Include a screenshot of the Gantt chart, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	1 Hour	3.75 Hours	3/24/26
Milestone 5		Progress Presentation		
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Provide the class with a project status update	1		
Summary	Show the class (client) what work has been completed toward the final project deliverables.	1		
Task M5A – Presentation	Present your work progress to the class	1		
Task M5B – Planning Document	Include screenshots of your presentation, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	1		
Milestone 6		Final Presentation		
Item	Description	Estimated Hours	Actual Hours	Date Completed
Purpose	Show your completed project to the class	1	1.5 Hours	5/1/2026
Summary	Share your hard work over the course of the semester with the class.	1 Hour	0.25 Hours	5/1/2026

Task M6A – Presentation	Present your completed project to the class	1 Hour	0.25 Hours	5/1/2026
Task M6B – Planning Document	Include screenshots of your final project deliverables and presentation, fill in the date each milestone task was completed in the milestone summary, and detail the additional milestone activities in the Milestone Summary section (insert new rows into the table).	1 Hour	1 Hour	5/1/2026

Resource List

Resource Name	W3 Schools
URL	https://www.w3schools.com/
Date Accessed	April 28, 2026
Notes	
Resource Name	JavaFX Basics
URL	https://dev.java/learn/javafx/structure/
Date Accessed	April 26, 2026
Notes	
Resource Name	Stack Overflow
URL	Stackoverflow.com
Date Accessed	April 30, 2026
Notes	
Resource Name	
URL	
Date Accessed	
Notes	
Resource Name	
URL	
Date Accessed	
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